settlement. They in turn had been inspired by the pioneering work of the late Dr Vishnu Wakankar, who has been called ‘the father of Indian rock art’. Dr Wakankar had spent several years studying early rock art in Europe, Egypt and the United States before returning to redraw the map of prehistoric rock art in India, his greatest coup coming in 1956 when he identified more than two hundred cave paintings contained within a large sandstone outcrop on the northern flank of the Vindhya range south of Bhopal, known to the local people as Bhimbetka, the ‘seat of Bhim’ – the mighty Bhima being one of the heroes of the *Mahabharata*. Supporting evidence in the form of microliths and simple petroglyphs (rock carvings) led Dr Wakankar to claim that some of the rock-shelters had initially been inhabited by *Homo erectus* at least a hundred thousand years ago and by *Homo sapiens* from thirty thousand years ago. Something approaching a thousand rock-shelters with paintings have since been discovered at the Bhimbetka complex, which in 2003 was declared a World Heritage Site.